MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準2級
リーディングトレーニング

第15回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全29問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜15	短文の語句空所補充
2	16〜20	会話文の空所補充
3	21〜22	長文の語句空所補充
4	23〜29	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検準2級形式のリーディング第15回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1 短文の語句空所補充

1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) Volunteers distributed bottled water and crackers to ( ) waiting at the shelter.

1 monuments **2** incidents **3** ingredients **4** residents

(2) In ( ) of the chilly wind, over three hundred runners joined the charity relay.

1 stead **2** spite **3** front **4** terms

(3) To prevent mold in June, open closet doors often to improve air ( ).

1 celebration **2** calculation **3** circulation **4** concentration

(4) The ceramic cup slipped out of my soapy hands and broke ( ) half a dozen pieces.

1 into **2** onto **3** over **4** among

(5) Judging ( ) the dark clouds gathering in the west, a thunderstorm is approaching.

1 over **2** with **3** into **4** from

(6) Our teacher warned us that mixing those two cleaners gives ( ) toxic gas.

1 off **2** up **3** in **4** away

(7) Grandpa still goes cycling every morning; he is young at ( ) at eighty.

1 mind **2** heart **3** head **4** hand

(8) This pass is valid for three days, ( ) tourists to stop on two islands.

1 allows **2** allowed **3** allowing **4** to allow

(9) I meant to return your umbrella yesterday, but it completely slipped my ( ).

1 brain **2** mind **3** sense **4** sight

(10) Without the lighthouse beam, the boat might have struck the ( ) reef.

1 mellow **2** hollow **3** narrow **4** shallow

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) Not until she tasted her own soup (　　) Mom realize she had used sugar instead of salt.

1 did　**2** was　**3** had　**4** does

(12) All summer interns are expected to dress neatly and be (　　) for morning briefings.

1 parallel　**2** partial　**3** punctual　**4** portable

(13) Because both teams finished with twelve points, the trophy was decided on goal (　　).

1 dependence　**2** distance　**3** diligence　**4** difference

(14) You can count (　　) Haruna to stay calm whenever technical trouble hits the stage.

1 at　**2** in　**3** on　**4** for

(15) Please attach a return address label just in case the parcel cannot be (　　).

1 departed　**2** delivered　**3** defended　**4** declined

2

会話文の空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(16) A: Excuse me. Can I take the 9:10 cable car down if fog rolls in earlier than forecast?
B: ( ) Your round-trip ticket works on any return car today.
A: Good to know—that gives us peace of mind!

1 Yes, there's no fixed return time.
2 No, tickets are only good next month.
3 Cable cars run under the ocean.
4 Fog is banned on this mountain.

(17) A: Why did Coach Yoshida make us jog barefoot on the turf for five minutes after practice?
B: ( ) Plus, the cool grass felt great on tired feet!
A: True—my ankles actually feel lighter.

1 Practice was canceled all week.
2 Because our shoes were stolen by birds.
3 Soccer is played without feet.
4 He said it strengthens tiny balance muscles in our feet.

(18) A: I'd love to bake lemon pound cake tonight, but we're out of fresh lemons.
B: ( ) Yuzu peel gives an even brighter citrus aroma!
A: Oh, brilliant! Let's zest two of them.

1 Then let's make beef curry without rice.
2 Grandma sent us a box of yuzu from Kochi yesterday!
3 Lemons grow on apple trees.
4 Our oven is at the library.

(19) A: How come the town library moved all the new magazines to the first-floor lobby?
B: ( ) Meanwhile, the second floor stays dead quiet for exam study.
A: That separation makes a lot of sense!

1 Nobody reads magazines anymore.
2 Because the second floor fell down.
3 So casual readers can chat softly by the coffee stand.
4 The library is moving overseas.

(20) A: Could you look over my English email to our sister school in Perth before I hit send?
B: ( ) Just change "Dear Teacher Smith" to "Dear Ms. Smith."
A: Catching that saved me from an awkward greeting—thanks!

1 Gladly! Overall it reads very politely.
2 I already deleted your computer.
3 Perth is in South America.
4 Never write emails in English.

3

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Manhole Covers Are Almost Always Round

Walk down almost any city street in the world, and the heavy cast-iron plates covering underground sewer and utility shafts share one unmistakable shape: they are round. Meanwhile, sidewalk grates for rainwater, subway ventilation panels, and telecom curb boxes are often rectangular. That contrast is no accident of tradition—civil engineers settled on circular manhole covers for hard-headed safety and practical reasons.

Consider what happens when workers lift a fifty-kilogram rectangular lid to climb down a ladder. Turned diagonally, a rectangle is narrower across its short side than across its corner-to-corner diagonal, meaning a careless slip could send the heavy iron plate plunging edge-first onto a technician below. A circle, by contrast, has the exact same diameter at every angle; resting on a slightly narrower circular lip inside the frame, a round cover physically (21).

Round lids simplify manufacturing and street work too. Foundries can turn circular rims smoothly on a lathe, workers never have to rotate a heavy cover to match corners when putting it back, and one worker can roll a round plate on its edge like a wheel instead of straining their back. Geometry here quietly protects (22).

(21)

1 melts automatically whenever snow touches the street

2 weighs less than a sheet of notebook paper in the rain

3 bounces back up like a rubber ball if dropped

4 cannot fall down through its own opening no matter how it is turned

(22)

1 underground workers from falling iron and street crews from back strain

2 car tires from ever needing air pressure checks

3 rainwater from entering city storm drains

4 pedestrians from walking on sidewalks

4 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Preparing for the Saturday Riverbank Reed Cutting

From: Kasumigaura Wetland Conservation Group
To: High School Volunteer Participants
Subject: Glove rules and parking change for Saturday's reed-cutting morning

Dear student volunteers,
Thank you for signing up for our annual winter reed cutting this Saturday, January 24 (9:00 a.m. – 11:30 a.m.)! Harvesting dry winter reeds lets spring sunlight warm the shallow water so reed warblers and native minnows thrive, and local craftspeople weave the bundled stalks into traditional summer blinds (sudare).

Dry reed leaves have microscopic silica edges sharp enough to slice thin cotton knit gloves. Please wear thick leather work gloves or rubber-coated gardening gloves—we have twenty extra pairs at the tent if you don't own any.

Because bridge repairs closed the North Lot, all school vans must drop students off at the South Boat Ramp instead.

Coordinator, Wetland Group

Preparing for the Saturday Riverbank Reed Cutting — Questions

(23) What happens to the bundled reed stalks harvested by volunteers?

1 They are dumped into deep ocean trenches.

2 Local craftspeople weave them into traditional summer blinds.

3 Volunteers take them home to feed pet dogs.

4 They are used to pave asphalt highways.

(24) Why shouldn't participants wear thin cotton knit gloves while cutting reeds?

1 Leather gloves are forbidden near rivers.

2 Cotton gloves melt when exposed to January sunlight.

3 Dry reed leaves have sharp silica edges that can slice through thin cotton.

4 Volunteers work with bare hands in cold water.

(25) Why must school vans drop students off at the South Boat Ramp this year?

1 The South Boat Ramp sells hot ramen.

2 Bridge repairs have closed the North Lot.

3 Reed cutting was moved to July.

4 Boats will carry vans across the lake.

How Hospital Gardens Speed Patient Recovery

Throughout much of the mid-twentieth century, modern hospital architecture prioritized sterile efficiency above all else. Landscaped courtyards that once surrounded nineteenth-century infirmaries were paved over for parking decks and diagnostic wings, leaving patient rooms facing blank brick walls or air-conditioning shafts.

A turning point arrived in 1984 when environmental psychologist Roger Ulrich examined ten years of surgical recovery charts at a suburban Pennsylvania hospital. Patients recovering from identical gallbladder operations had been assigned randomly to rooms along one corridor: half looked out on a small stand of deciduous trees, while the other half faced a plain brown brick wall. Patients with the tree view requested significantly fewer strong painkillers, reported lower anxiety to nurses, and went home nearly a full day sooner on average.

Follow-up clinical studies in Japan, Sweden, and the United States confirmed that visual and physical contact with greenery lowers stress hormones such as cortisol and steadies heart rate—not only in patients, but also among exhausted ICU nurses and family caregivers taking ten-minute breaks.

Today, architects design "healing gardens" onto hospital rooftops and inner courtyards with careful medical input. Smooth, glare-free paths accommodate wheelchairs and IV poles safely; fragrant herbs and seasonal blossoms help stroke patients rebuild sensory orientation, while toxic or heavy-pollen plants are excluded near allergy wards.

Greenery cannot replace skilled surgeons or antibiotics, of course, yet restoring nature to hospital grounds treats the human nervous system alongside the illness.

How Hospital Gardens Speed Patient Recovery — Questions

(26) What difference separated the two groups of surgical patients in Roger Ulrich's 1984 study?

1 One group exercised two hours a day on a rooftop track.

2 One group had surgery in winter and the other in summer.

3 One group stayed at home without doctors.

4 One group's windows faced deciduous trees, while the other group's faced a plain brick wall.

(27) What recovery outcomes were observed in patients whose rooms looked out onto trees?

1 They needed fewer strong painkillers and were discharged nearly a day earlier on average.

2 They stayed in the hospital twice as long to watch birds.

3 They required three times more antibiotics.

4 Their surgical scars vanished within an hour.

(28) Besides patients, who else benefits from hospital greenery according to follow-up studies?

1 Surgeons while performing operations outdoors.

2 Only parking-lot ticket machines.

3 Tired hospital staff such as ICU nurses and visiting family caregivers.

4 Ambulance tires on snowy highways.

(29) What practical design details are included in modern hospital "healing gardens"?

1 Sand pits that block all wheelchairs from entering.

2 Steep rock-climbing cliffs and thorny poisonous bushes.

3 Loudspeakers broadcasting traffic news all afternoon.

4 Wheelchair- and IV-friendly glare-free paths, sensory herbs, and avoidance of high-pollen plants.